

Influencing interlocutors: On Operation Sindoor, India's delegations

The delegations projected a united image of pluralistic India

The seven Indian **delegations** of mostly Members of Parliament and some former **diplomats**, tasked by the government to carry **diplomatic** messages after Operation Sindoor, **have** completed their travels. The 59 members visited 32 countries to **convey** the country's position on the **outrage** felt over the Pahalgam terror attack and its links to Pakistan, the **restrained** and **precise** nature of Indian strikes on Pakistan's terrorist **infrastructure**, and the "**new normal**" the government has adopted for terrorist strikes. The message was meant not just for foreign governments but also for **lawmakers**, the foreign media and the general public, especially in countries where New Delhi has felt it has not found the expected support. **Many** of the countries visited **are** members of the UN Security Council (UNSC), and include those which are elected non-permanent members or will join next year. This is important as India faced a diplomatic **setback** when **Pakistan**, an elected UNSC member for 2025-26, **was** able to **amend** the UNSC statement to **omit** references to The Resistance Front (TRF) that had claimed responsibility for the Pahalgam attack. **That** Pakistan **managed to** be chosen **Chair** of the Taliban Sanctions committee and Vice-Chair of the UN Counter-terrorism Committee **will** make India's task of **holding the terrorists responsible for the attack accountable** through UN **designations** and at the Financial Action Task Force more difficult. Another area of focus was the membership of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation that has been particularly **critical of** India. Finally, the focus on the U.S. was **pointed**, where the delegation visited New York and Washington. This may have **stemmed from** the appearance that **ties** with Washington **are strained** over President Donald Trump's **persistent** claim that he had **mediated** the **ceasefire** between India and Pakistan, using trade ties as a **leverage to avert** a "nuclear conflict".

It remains to be seen just how successful these **tours** of political diplomacy **have** been, **given criticism** in India that more time was spent speaking to the Indian **diaspora**, and giving interviews to the **accompanying** Indian media rather than in influencing interlocutors abroad. The delegations also had to **contend with** a **copy-cat** move from Pakistan to **counter** the Indian **narrative**. However, the **overarching message** of the delegations, comprising **representatives** from a number of Indian States, faiths and political parties, **is** a powerful one — of Indian unity and **consensus** on the issue of national security. At a time when the Modi government is under criticism internationally for "democratic decline" and increasing **majoritarianism**, New Delhi chose its **messengers** wisely, **with a view to** projecting abroad a positive and pluralistic image of a country that was **resolute** against terrorism.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

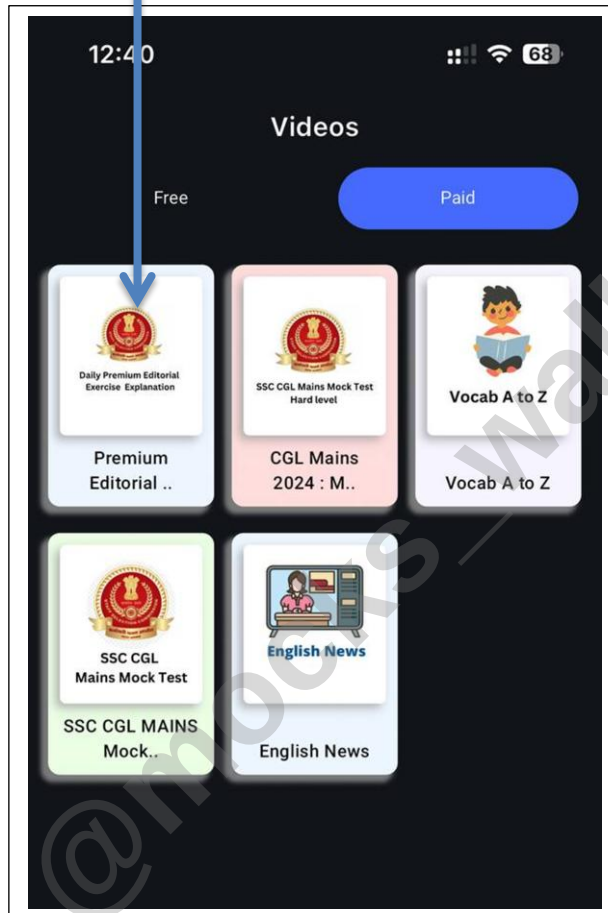
1. **Interlocutor** (noun) – speaker, negotiator, representative, discussant, spokesperson
वार्ताकार
2. **Delegation** (noun) – group, mission, envoy, deputation, panel प्रतिनिधिमंडल
3. **Project** (verb) – present, display, express, communicate, portray प्रस्तुत करना
4. **United** (adjective) – unified, cohesive, allied, combined, harmonious एकजुट
5. **Pluralistic** (adjective) – diverse, inclusive, multicultural, multifaceted, tolerant
बहुलवादी
6. **Diplomat** (noun) – envoy, ambassador, consul, emissary, negotiator राजनयिक
7. **Diplomatic** (adjective) – tactful, political, discreet, strategic, official कूटनीतिक
8. **Convey** (verb) – communicate, express, transfer, deliver, share बताना / पहुँचाना
9. **Outrage** (noun) – fury, indignation, anger, shock, resentment आक्रोश
10. **Restrained** (adjective) – controlled, moderate, subdued, measured, calm
संयमित
11. **Precise** (adjective) – exact, accurate, specific, definite, clear सटीक
12. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, facilities, system, structure
आधारभूत ढांचा
13. **New normal** (noun) – a previously unfamiliar or atypical situation that has become standard, usual, or expected. नई सामान्य स्थिति
14. **Lawmaker** (noun) – legislator, MP, policymaker, senator, representative सांसद / कानून निर्माता
15. **Setback** (noun) – defeat, obstacle, failure, reversal, hindrance झटका
16. **Amend** (verb) – revise, alter, modify, change, correct संशोधन करना
17. **Omit** (verb) – exclude, leave out, skip, neglect, bypass छोड़ देना
18. **Manage** (to) (verb) – succeed in, accomplish, achieve, be able to, handle सफल होना
19. **Chair** (noun) – head, leader, president, moderator, presiding officer अध्यक्ष
20. **Hold someone responsible for** (phrase) – blame, charge, make liable, accuse, attribute accountability जिम्मेदार ठहराना
21. **Accountable** (adjective) – answerable, liable, responsible, obligated, culpable
उत्तरदायी

22. **Designation** (noun) – title, classification, appointment, label, status नामित स्थिति
23. **Critical** (of) (adjective) – judgmental, disapproving, unfavorable, fault-finding, skeptical आलोचनात्मक
24. **Pointed** (adjective) – direct, sharp, specific, clear, focused विशेष रूप से निर्देशित
25. **Stem from** (phrasal verb) – originate from, arise from, result from, come from, derive from उत्पन्न होना
26. **Ties** (noun) – relations, connections, associations, links, bonds संबंध
27. **Strained** (adjective) – tense, uneasy, troubled, stressed, difficult तनावपूर्ण
28. **Persistent** (adjective) – continuous, unrelenting, constant, stubborn, enduring लगातार
29. **Mediate** (verb) – arbitrate, negotiate, intervene, reconcile, facilitate मध्यस्थता करना
30. **Ceasefire** (noun) – truce, armistice, suspension of hostilities, peace agreement युद्धविराम
31. **Leverage** (verb) – use, exploit, utilize, harness, apply प्रभाव डालना / लाभ लेना
32. **Avert** (verb) – prevent, avoid, stop, deter, ward off रोकना
33. **Given** (preposition) – considering, in view of, taking into account, assuming देखते हुए
34. **Criticism** (noun) – disapproval, censure, critique, faultfinding, condemnation आलोचना
35. **Diaspora** (noun) – expatriates, migrant community, overseas population, dispersed group प्रवासी समुदाय
36. **Accompanying** (adjective) – attending, associated, following, related, going along साथ जाने वाला
37. **Contend** (with) (verb) – deal with, face, grapple with, struggle against, confront सामना करना
38. **Copy-cat** (adjective) – imitative, duplicate, replica-based, mimic, cloned नकल करने वाला
39. **Counter** (verb) – oppose, rebut, challenge, dispute, resist मुकाबला करना
40. **Narrative** (noun) – story, account, portrayal, depiction, perspective कथा / विवरण
41. **Overarching** (adjective) – comprehensive, all-encompassing, overall, general, wide-ranging व्यापक
42. **Representative** (noun) – delegate, spokesperson, agent, envoy, emissary प्रतिनिधि

43. **Consensus** (noun) – agreement, harmony, unity, accord, unanimity आम सहमति
44. **Majoritarianism** (noun) – majority rule, dominance of majority, populism, authoritarian democracy बहुसंख्यवाद
45. **Messenger** (noun) – envoy, bearer, communicator, carrier, representative संदेशवाहक
46. **With a view to** (phrase) – with the aim of, for the purpose of, intending to, aiming at उद्देश्य से
47. **Resolute** (adjective) – determined, firm, unwavering, steadfast, strong-minded दृढ़

@mocks_wallah

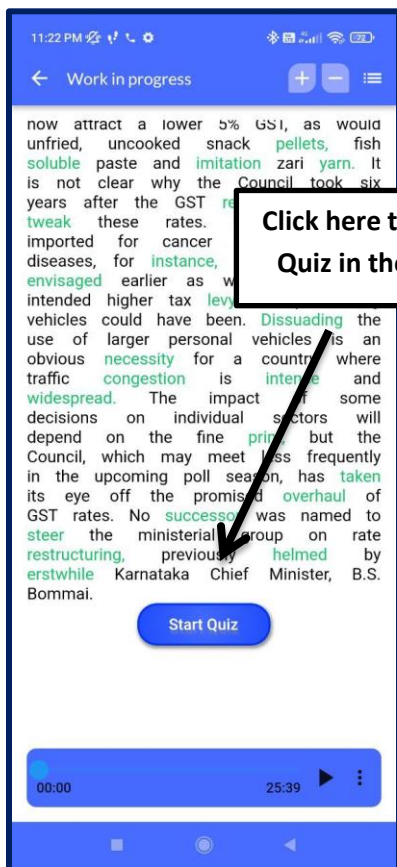
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. **Delegation Diplomacy Post-Operation Sindoor:** Seven Indian delegations, mainly comprising MPs and ex-diplomats, were sent to 32 countries after the Pahalgam terror attack.
2. **Purpose of the Visits:** The aim was to explain India's restrained response to terrorism, especially strikes on Pakistan-based infrastructure, and promote the government's "new normal" on terror retaliation.
3. **Global Messaging:** The delegations targeted not only foreign governments but also lawmakers, media, and public opinion in nations where India sought more diplomatic backing.
4. **UNSC Outreach:** Several of the countries visited are members of the UN Security Council — both current and upcoming non-permanent members — critical for building global support.
5. **Diplomatic Setback at UNSC:** India faced a setback when Pakistan influenced UNSC language to remove reference to The Resistance Front (TRF), which had claimed the Pahalgam attack.
6. **Pakistan's Strategic Positions:** Pakistan's appointment as Chair of the Taliban Sanctions Committee and Vice-Chair of the UN Counter-terrorism Committee may hinder India's efforts to isolate terrorists.
7. **OIC's Criticism of India:** The delegations also targeted the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC), which has been consistently critical of India on Kashmir-related issues.
8. **Focus on the U.S.:** A strong focus was laid on the U.S., with visits to New York and Washington amidst concerns over claims of U.S. mediation in India-Pakistan tensions.
9. **Concerns Over India-U.S. Relations:** Delegates addressed perceived strains in U.S.-India ties, particularly related to Donald Trump's claims and trade-linked diplomacy.
10. **Domestic Criticism of the Tours:** Some Indian critics argued that the delegations spent more time engaging with Indian diaspora and Indian media than with foreign policymakers.
11. **Pakistan's Counter-Diplomacy:** Pakistan mounted a parallel diplomatic campaign to challenge and counter India's narrative globally.
12. **Diverse Representation:** The Indian delegations included members from different states, faiths, and political parties, symbolizing internal consensus on terrorism.
13. **Projection of Pluralism:** The composition of the delegations helped portray India as a unified, pluralistic democracy committed to counterterrorism.
14. **Strategic Messaging:** The government aimed to counter international criticism of democratic backsliding and majoritarianism by projecting a balanced, inclusive national image.
15. **Diplomatic Impact Unclear:** The effectiveness of this political diplomacy remains to be fully assessed, but it was a significant soft power effort to shape global opinion.

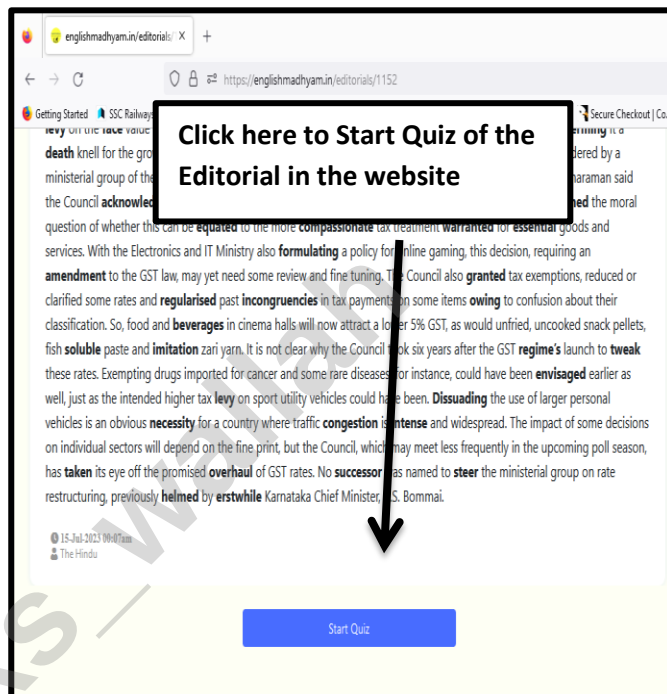
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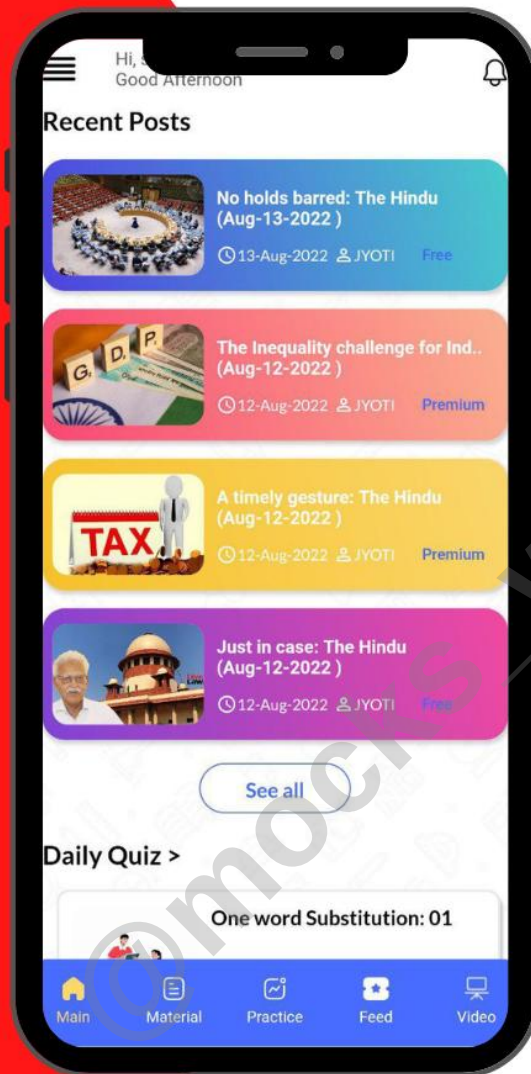
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